BENJAMIN HISLOP

Solutions Architect, AI Innovation & Delivery

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SUMMARY

Solutions Architect and hands-on engineer with 8 years of experience building web platforms for automotive and manufacturing clients including Mopar, Dana, and Peterbilt. I design cloud and CMS architectures, lead technical delivery across 3–4 concurrent projects, and run AI adoption at The JRT Agency. Co-founder of StageFinder, a live-music ticketing platform I architected and built end to end.

EXPERIENCE

Co-Founder, Product & Engineering · The StageFinder — Mar 2026 – Present · Denver, CO

- Co-founded a live-music discovery and ticketing platform with one partner. I own product, engineering, and DevOps; the public beta is live at stagefinder.fm.
- Architected the stack: Go REST API, Postgres (Supabase, sqlc), and a Next.js / React / TypeScript front end, with S3 media storage and an AWS hosting migration in progress. Replaced a third-party headless CMS with first-party data models to cut vendor dependency.
- Built ticketing on Stripe Connect with itemized pass-through fees, so the platform never absorbs processing costs, plus checkout capacity limits, owner payouts, and QR-code check-in.
- Built role-based admin tools and a booking-consent workflow that lets promoters request claimed artists and venues.

The JRT Agency · Farmington, MI (Remote) — Dec 2018 – Present

Solutions Architect, AI Innovation & Delivery — Aug 2026 – Present

- **Technical project management** (Apr 2026 – present)**:** Run 3–4 concurrent client projects with a team of 7 developers in Jira, designing sprint cadences for some projects and managing kanban boards for others.
- **Client consulting** (ongoing)**:** Work directly with clients on nearly every project, joining kickoffs as both PM and technical lead, running requirements sessions with client stakeholders and their engineers (including platform and integration requirements for a Shopify build), and presenting plans and recommendations.
- **Architecture documentation** (ongoing)**:** Produce architecture diagrams for review by our data team, systems administrator, and developers, and polished handover documentation when a client takes over day-to-day operation.
- **Cost reduction** (Aug 2026 – present)**:** Moved seven Vimeo accounts, each set to rise from about $200 to $4,800 per year, to Bunny Stream ($12–$60/yr) and SproutVideo ($144/yr), avoiding roughly $33,600 a year in increases.
- **Migrations** (Sep 2026 – present)**:** Designed, implemented, and delegated multisite migrations from dotCMS to CrafterCMS, saving clients $30,000 a year in licensing fees.
- **Cloud & commerce architecture** (Jun – Sep 2026)**:** Designed AWS architectures for two client sites (Lightsail; EC2 with MariaDB and MySQL), each with dev and production environments, and ecommerce strategies connecting client ERP systems with Shopify.
- **Front-end platform** (Jul 2026)**:** Prototyped consolidating Vue apps under one pnpm workspace to end version drift, and eliminated merge conflicts caused by committing dist files.
- **AI enablement** (Jan 2026 – present)**:** Led two company-wide Claude trainings (prompting; Claude Design) for 50+ attendees each, plus small-group sessions of 4–6 people tailored to each team's workflow, including working with Claude in OneDrive.
- **AI tooling** (Jun 2026 – present)**:** Build reusable Claude skills on request with coworkers (UTM generation, news-article formatting) and CrafterCMS plugins in the rich-text editor that draft copy in company tone from existing content. Built AI-assisted Lighthouse and accessibility audits, tailored per site and run monthly across all of the agency's sites.

Senior Frontend Web Developer May 2023 – Aug 2026

- Founded and led a 4-person AI Innovation Team that piloted AI tools in agency project planning, and wrote a bi-weekly newsletter on practical AI uses.
- Built enterprise services on Java, Spring Boot, and Hibernate with S3-backed asset storage.
- Owned project budgets, plans, and resourcing with PM teams, and mentored junior developers through code review in Vue 3 and Nuxt 3.
- Received the 2024 Employee Outstanding Achievement Award for technical leadership and innovation.

Frontend Web Developer Dec 2018 – May 2023

- Modeled content for client-driven sites in dotCMS and CrafterCMS and built custom Sanity.io dashboards.
- Moved legacy sites to headless architectures and maintained Angular, Ionic, and Vue applications.
- Served as accessibility lead for B2C sites and scoped client requests into technical quotes and hour estimates.

Earlier career: Support Services Specialist, Kelly Services (2017–2018); restaurant management, including teams of 20+ staff (2010–2016).

SKILLS

Architecture & Delivery: Solution design, cloud architecture (AWS Lightsail, EC2, S3), CMS migrations, ecommerce / ERP integration, project estimating and budgeting

AI: Claude (skills, plugins, Claude Code), prompt design, team training and enablement, workflow automation

Frontend: TypeScript, React, Next.js, Vue 3, Nuxt 3, Angular, Tailwind, Vite, pnpm, HTML5, CSS / Sass

Backend & Data: Go, Java, Spring Boot, Hibernate, REST, GraphQL, PostgreSQL, MySQL, MariaDB, sqlc

CMS & Commerce: CrafterCMS, dotCMS, Sanity.io, Shopify, MODX, Velocity, FreeMarker

Payments & Infra: Stripe Connect, Supabase, Railway, Docker, Lighthouse and accessibility audits

Process & Quality: Jira, Agile (sprints, kanban), WCAG accessibility, SEO, responsive design

Also: Python (Pandas, scikit-learn, Streamlit), Tableau, SQL / NoSQL

EDUCATION

Metropolitan State University of Denver — B.S., Computer Science, Dec 2025, *Cum Laude*
Provost's Honor Roll · Upsilon Pi Epsilon · National Society of Leadership and Success · Stat Science Club, Vice President

Red Rocks Community College — A.S., Mathematics, 2015